Functions can return a value using the `return` statement. If no `return` statement is present, the function returns `None`.

```
def square(num):
    return num ** 2

result = square(4)  # result is 16
```

Scope of Variables:

Variable scope defines the region where a variable can be accessed. Python has two main types of scope:

Local Scope: Variables defined inside a function are local to that function and cannot be accessed outside it.

```
def example():
    x = 10  # Local variable
    print(x)

example()
# print(x)  # Error: x is not defined outside the function
```

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Global Scope: Variables defined outside any function are global and can be accessed anywhere in the code.

```
x = 10  # Global variable
```